



Think College Webinar Series
January 18, 2023

Planning for College Success Now: Recommendations for IEP Teams

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Agenda

Introduction & Background

Lessons Learned

Tips for preparing students with
disabilities in K-12 years

IEP connections

Additional resources



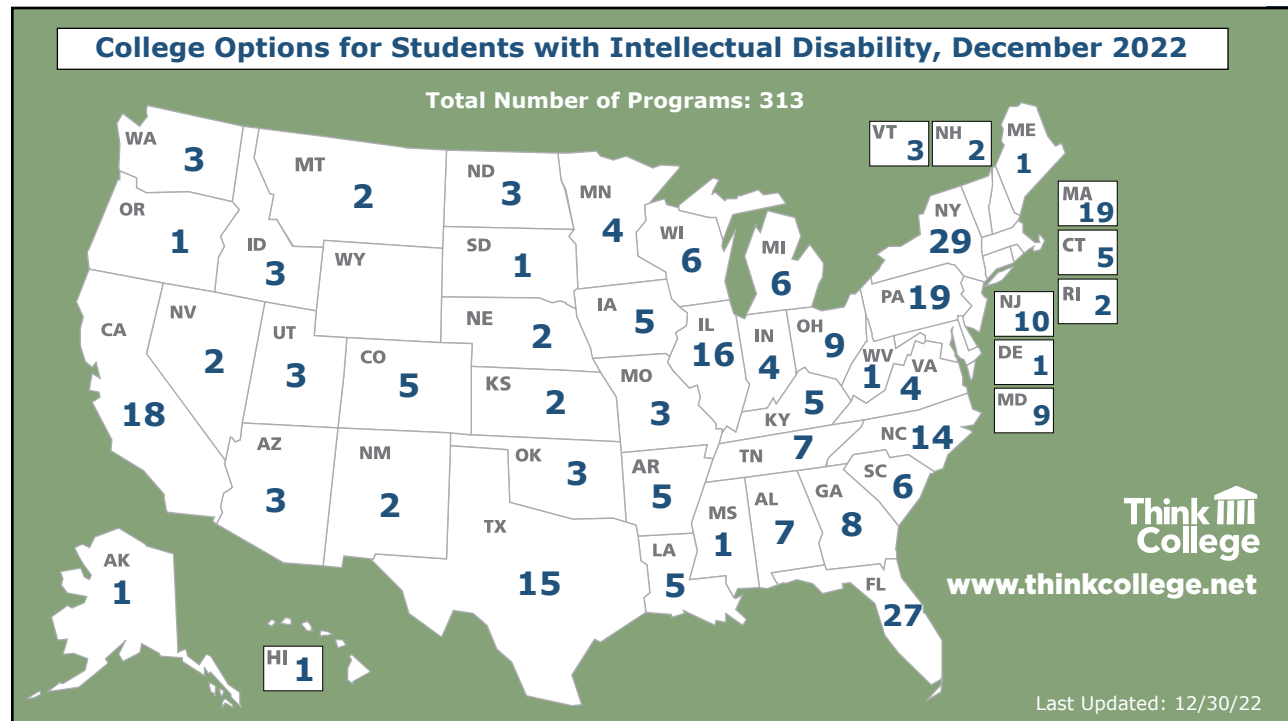
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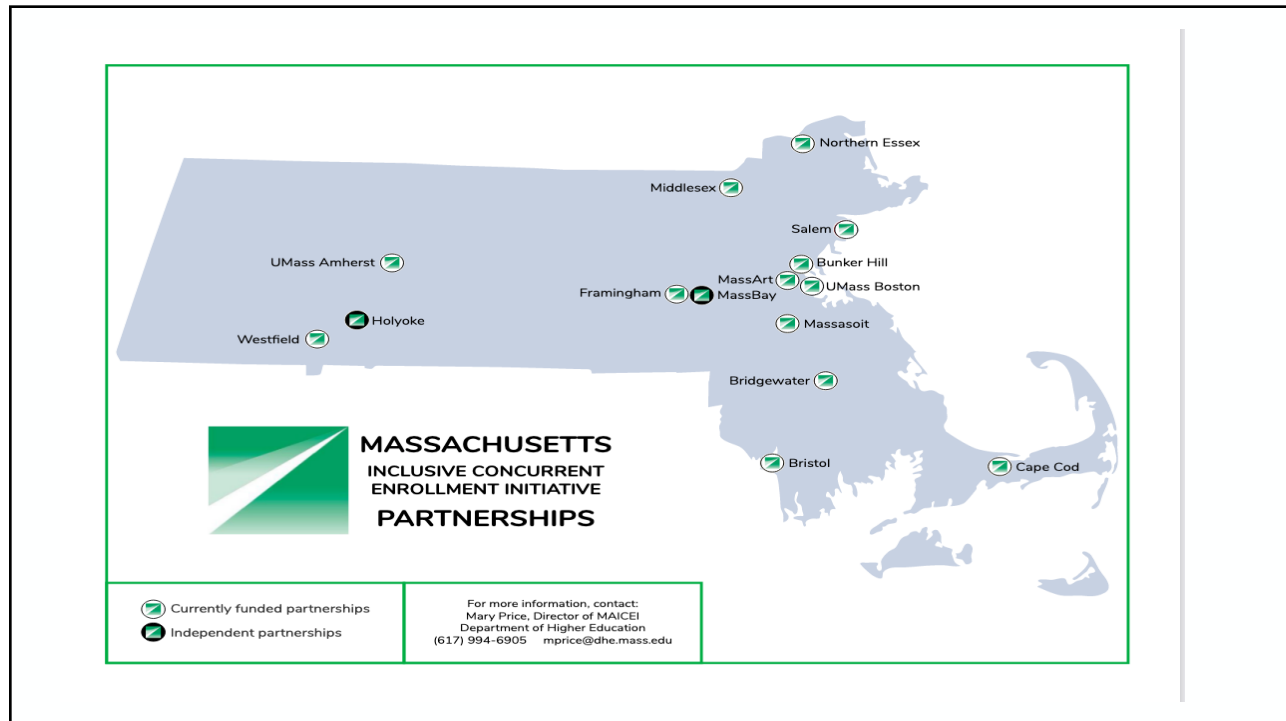
A little background



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OVERVIEW OF MA Inclusive Higher Education (2007-PRESENT)

Students are fully included in the campus community as they develop their capacities in

- career-planning
- employment
- self-advocacy
- other self-determined abilities supporting their interests and activities

Students participate in:

College or university courses that support their goals

Social activities on campus, student organizations, other extracurricular activities

Person-centered planning

Paid work and internships

Independent living and independent travel

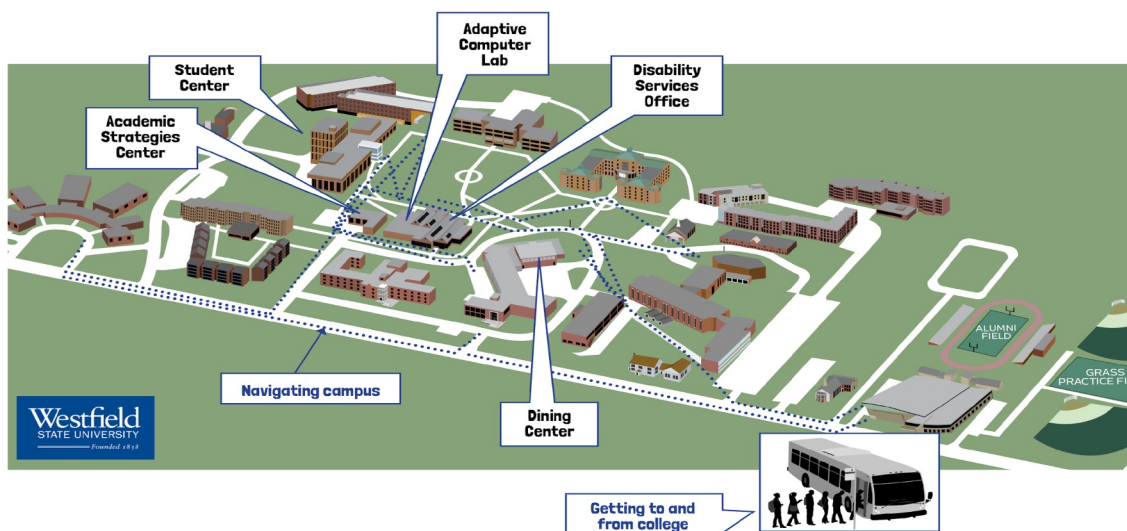
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Lessons Learned

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College Campus

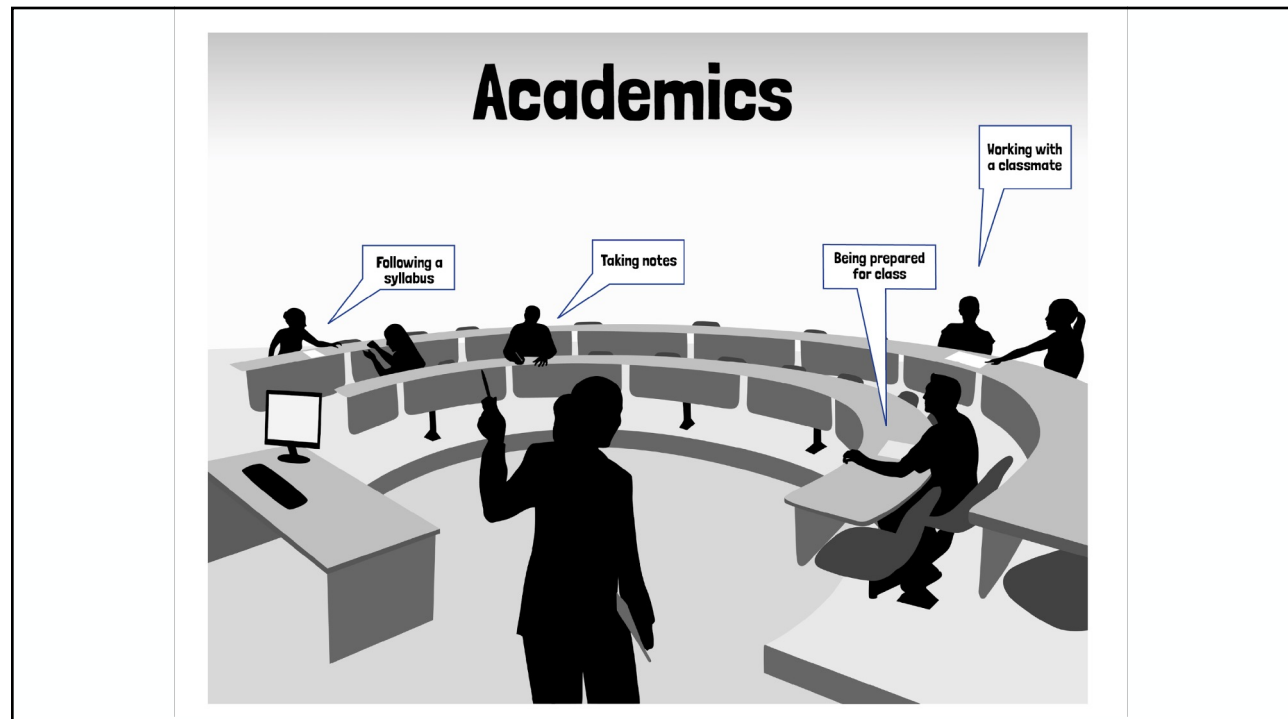


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College Campus Participation

College expectation	Secondary preparation
Getting to and from college	Early use of alternative public transport; apply for ADA/regional transit options. Build opportunities to plan travel to/from school and navigate independently. Plan free time.
Disability services	Review IEP regularly to confirm successful learning accommodation strategies/ self-identify disability
Academic Strategies Center/Adaptive Computer Lab	Build in opportunities to use accommodations rather than modifications/ review technology used in IHEs.

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Academic Preparation

College expectation	Secondary preparation
Communicating with instructor	Discussing accommodations with teachers; discussing support; communication with teacher(e.g., absence, running late, set up meeting)
Following a syllabus	Reading and following a high school syllabus
Being prepared for class	Following checklist to complete prep: readings, notes, anticipated topics for discussion. Become familiar with using learning management systems.

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Academic Reading

- IEP: Three-year evaluations. Look for progress in Academic Information and Achievement.
- Summary of Performance: Reading and successful strategies

THE WRITING CENTER • University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

POINTMENTS SUBMIT A DRAFT TIPS & TOOLS BLOG **ENGLISH LANGUAGE** FACULTY AND GRADS ABOUT DONATE

Academic Reading Strategies

Completing reading assignments is one of the biggest challenges in academia. However, are you managing your reading efficiently? Consider this cooking analogy, noting the differences in process:

Shannon has to make dinner. He goes to the store and walks through every aisle. He decides to make spaghetti, so he revisits aisles and reads many packages thoroughly before deciding which groceries to buy. Once he arrives home, he finds a recipe for spaghetti, but needs to go back to the store for ingredients he forgot.

Taylor also has to make dinner. He wants lots of carbohydrates because he's running a marathon soon so he decides to make spaghetti. After checking some recipes, he makes a list of ingredients. At the grocery store, he skims aisles to find his ingredients and chooses products that meet his diet.

Taylor's process was more efficient because his purpose was clear. Establishing why you are reading something will help you decide how to read it, which saves time and improves comprehension. This guide lists some purposes for reading as well as different strategies to use at different stages of the reading process.

Purposes for reading

People read different kinds of text (e.g., scholarly articles, textbooks, reviews) for different reasons. Some purposes for reading might be:

- to scan for specific information
- to skim to get an overview of the text
- to relate new content to existing knowledge
- to write something (often depends on a prompt)
- to critique an argument
- to learn something

English Language Support

- Mini-Courses
- Writing Groups
- Speaking Groups
- Workshops
- Resources
- ESL FAQs

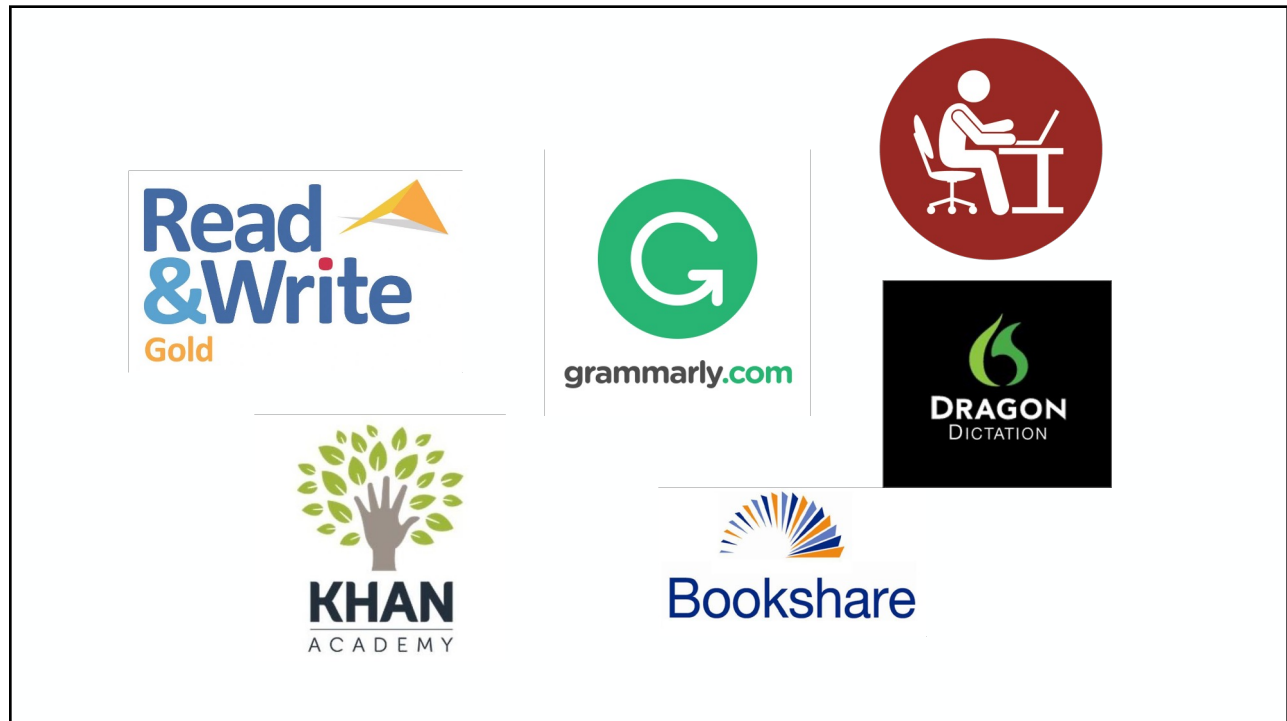
Newsletter Signup

To receive regular updates about English language support services and resources, please join our mailing list.

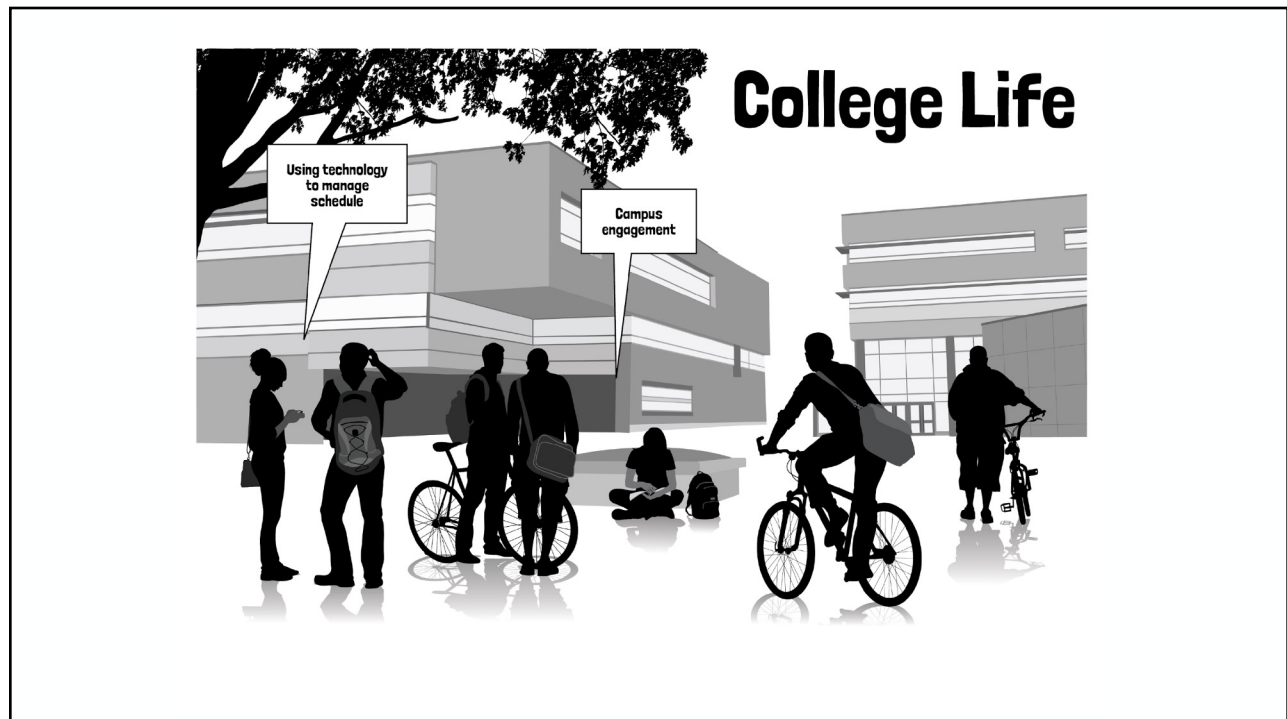
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College Life Participation

College expectation	Secondary preparation
Using technology to manage schedule	Build in opportunities for students to develop their own weekly schedule, make and record appts
Campus engagement: fitness center	Support students to build in fitness and sports as preferred and with a partner
Campus engagement: clubs	Support students to explore interests in high school or community clubs

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 Predictors of Postschool Success • Evidence-based • Research-based • Promising	Predictors/Outcomes	Education	Employment	Independent Living
	Career awareness	Promising	Promising	
	Career technical education	Research-based	Evidence-based	
	Community experiences		Promising	
	Goal setting	Research-based	Research-based	Research-based
	Inclusion in general education	Research-based	Research-based	Research-based
	Interagency collaboration	Promising	Promising	
	Occupational courses	Promising	Promising	
	Paid employment/work experience	Research-based	Research-based	Promising
	Parent expectations	Promising	Research-based	
	Parent involvement		Promising	
	Program of study	Research-based	Research-based	
	Psychological empowerment	Promising	Promising	Promising
	Self-care/independent living skills	Promising	Promising	Research-based
	Self-determination/self-advocacy	Research-based	Research-based	Promising
	Self-realization		Promising	Promising
	Social skills	Promising	Promising	
	Student support	Promising	Research-based	Promising
	Technology skills		Promising	
	Transition program	Research-based	Promising	
	Travel skills		Promising	
	Work study		Research-based	
	Youth autonomy/decision-making	Research-based	Research-based	Promising

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Connections to IEPs



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NTACT Indicator 13 Checklist



1. Measurable Postsecondary Goals
2. Updated annually
3. Based upon transition assessments
4. Transition Services
5. Course of Study
6. Annual IEP goals aligned with transition service needs
7. Student invite
8. Agency invite with consent

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Connecting the Indicator 13 checklist to college- bound/college-based transition services



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**Measurable
postsecondary
goals; updated
annually:**

**Goals specify the
student's plans for
life after high
school.**

- Staff collaborate to facilitate person-centered planning
- Transition staff administer career interest surveys
- Student identifies vision for work, training and community living.

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Examples



- Carmen will take college classes that will help her to secure a graphic design or printing position at a print shop upon leaving school in June 2023.
- Joseph will go to college, live in a dorm and then get a job as an office assistant in a medical office after he leaves school in June 2024.
- Dae will study history, live with roommates in an apartment and work in a museum when he leaves school in June 2023.

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Transition assessment:

Tools that help students identify their strengths, interests, skills, and/or knowledge needed to reach their goals for life after high school.



IEP team members collaborate to conduct transition assessments.

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Examples of transition assessment plans

Carmen (college, print shop job)	Joseph (college, dorm, office job)	Dae (college, apt, museum job)
Task analysis results: Traveling to school using bus; shared ride	Task analysis results: Arranging own paratransit rides to and from school, home, work	Text communications with transition specialist: travel to school, internship, home
Checklist documenting accommodations used to complete reading assignments. Results of reading evaluation.	Record of weekly schedules on his iPad to complete class assignments on time	Observation notes of student using accommodations to communicate with teachers, classmates, peers
Grades and assignments from Intro to Graphic Arts class	Grades and assignments from Intro to Data Entry course	Grades and assignments from history course
Results of social skills survey administered over 5 days at school or work	Results of independent living assessment with consulting OT or IL staff	Task analysis results: Completing work at museum gift store

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Examples of other formal and informal assessments used by transition and special ed staff

Student-Coach Agreement
Reading Comprehension
Kuder Navigator Career Assessment
Landmark's Guide to Assessing College Readiness
Work-Based Learning Plan
Transition Planning Inventory, 2nd Ed.
Person-Centered Planning
CITE Learning Style Inventory
Informal tools
ARC's Self Determination Scale
Vineland Adaptive Behavior Scales

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Transition services: FAPE and LRE; coordinated, results-oriented, accounts for student preferences, age-appropriate.

Student vision	Education	Employment/ training	Independent living
Carmen: college, print shop, travel	Intro to Graphic Art; English class	Working in a print shop 2 days a week	Learning to use public transportation
Transition specialist	X	X	X
Related services		X	X
Assistive technology	X	X	X
Career-Voc specialist		X	
Gen Ed or College coordinator	X		

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Secondary Curriculum with Results-Oriented Curriculum and Instruction

Day/time	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
7:30-8:00	Travel to school	Travel to school	Travel to school	Travel to school	Travel to school
8:00-8:30	Math	Career Prep	Phys Ed	Career Prep	Fine arts class
8:30-9:30	ELA	Math	Health class	Off-site service learning	Health class
9:30-10:30	Computer Applications/Tech	ELA	Math		Academic Support/Tech
10:30-11:30			ELA	Math	Computer applications
11:30-12:30	Lunch/ Study	Lunch/ Study	Lunch/ Study	Lunch/ Study	Lunch/ Study
12:30-1:30	Academic Support	Fine arts class	Computer Applications	ELA	Math
1:30-2:30	Elective related to postschool vision	Academic Support	Elective related to vision	Academic Support	ELA

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**Course of study: College-based Transition Services.
Reasonably enables student to meet postsecondary goals.**

Day/Time	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
8:00	Metro/Shuttle to school	Metro to job	Metro/Shuttle to school	Metro to job	Metro/Shuttle to school
9:00	GRA 104 Intro to Screen Printing	Paid work at printing shop	GRA 104 Intro to Screen Printing	Paid work at printing shop	GRA 104 Intro to Screen Printing
10:00	Academic tutoring with coach or teacher aide		Academic tutoring with coach or teacher aide		Academic tutoring with coach or teacher aide
11:00	Athletic center or game room	College-Career Planning (job coach) meeting	Athletic center or game room	College-Career Planning (job coach) meeting	Athletic center or game room
12:00	Lunch	Lunch break at work	Lunch	Lunch break at work	Lunch
1:00		Library: check email; work on assignments	Check in with peer mentor	Library: check email; work on assignments	Career workshops
2:00	WRI 101 College Writing prep	Metro to home	WRI 101 College Writing prep	Metro to home	WRI 101 College Writing prep
3:00	Shuttle/Metro to home		Shuttle/Metro to home		Shuttle/Metro to home

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Annual goals: Related to transition services needs



By the end of the 2022-2023 school year, Carmen will:

- have successfully completed two classes that relate to her interest in graphics and printing.
- communicate with her teachers via email, text or in person discussions to discuss class concerns.
- navigate independently to attend her classes, eat lunch in the cafeteria and participate in two additional school activities each week such as a club meeting or tutoring

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Related goal development resources in the
**Think College
 Online Resource
 Library**



- Becht, 2023. Transition IEP Goals and Activities to Prepare for Inclusive Postsecondary Education.
- Boyle's 2017 Inclusive Dual Enrollment Student Evaluation Tool.
- Hart, Boyle, and Jones' 2017 Foundational Skills for the College and Career Learning Plan.

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Benchmarks

Benchmarks are measurable indicators of student progress, used to describe the skills the student will acquire to meet an annual goal.

Examples:

By ____, Carmen will meet with teacher/guidance counselor in an advising meeting and advocate for at least one class of interest every quarter .

By ____, Carmen will independently ask her teacher questions if she is unsure of expectations or needs for 4 out of 5 targeted opportunities.

By ____, Carmen will independently navigate the school, getting to her destination for 4 out of 5 targeted opportunities.

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Additional resources



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Promoting College and Career Readiness: Practical Strategies for the Classroom

By Monahan, J., Lombardi, A., & Madaus, J. (2018).

TEACHING Exceptional Children
doi.org/10.1177/0040059918802579

Domain	Definition	Instructional strategies
Academic engagement	Acquisition of academic knowledge through interacting and engaging with the content	Utilize guided notes to teach academic content
Mind-sets	Mentality that an individual can and will do well	• Provide positive feedback • Allow failure and help students reflect and improve • Foster an ownership of learning
Learning processes	Test taking, studying, time management, and meaningfully engaging with the content	Teach students backward design/mapping
Critical thinking	Problem solving, research, interpretation, communication, and precision/accuracy	Hold classroom debates using graphic organizers
Interpersonal engagement	Interacting with self, others, and associated internal processes	• Create opportunities for collaboration and reflection • Promote adaptability within the classroom
Transition competencies	Confidence in new roles and responsibilities as an adult	Encourage self-determination

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Tips for IEP Teams to Help Students and Families Prepare for Inclusive Postsecondary Education



Tips for IEP Teams to Help Students and Families Prepare for Inclusive Postsecondary Education

By Barb Ziemke, PACER's National Parent Center on Transition and Employment

With about 300 postsecondary programs for students with intellectual disability across the country, more students are college-bound than ever before. The goal of high school and transition planning is to prepare students with intellectual disability for life after high school. How can individualized Education Program (IEP) teams help prepare students for success in college? Use the checklist and related resources below to guide the selection of transition goals and activities that will likely be key factors in making the possibility of college a reality.

IDENTIFY AND EXPLORE OPTIONS

- ☐ Are the student and family aware of postsecondary options for students with intellectual disabilities and typical admission requirements?
- ☐ Have the student and family toured a postsecondary education program?
- ☐ Have the student and family learned about financial planning strategies to help pay for college?
- ☐ Has the family been connected to the IDEA-funded Parent Training and Information Center in their state for information and referral to agencies that may fund or provide adult disability services and supports?

Resources

- » PACER web page on Postsecondary Education for Students with Intellectual Disability
- » Engaging Parents in Conversations About College-Based Transition Services
- » Conducting a College Search: Questions to Ask College Programs
- » College Planning Timeline
- » Federal Financial Aid for Students with Intellectual Disabilities
- » Achieving a Better Life Experience (ABLE) Act: Frequently Asked Questions

PROMOTE HIGH EXPECTATIONS, INCLUSION, AND INCREASED INDEPENDENCE

- ☐ Is the IEP process student-focused with a foundation of strengths-based transition assessment?
- ☐ Do all members of the IEP team have high expectations for post-school training and employment?
- ☐ Is the student participating in inclusive classrooms, clubs, and community-based activities while in high school?
- ☐ Have the student and family been exposed to mentors or other individuals with disabilities that are participating in inclusive postsecondary education programs or competitive integrated employment?
- ☐ Does the student have chores and responsibilities at home and ways to contribute or volunteer at school or in the community?

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Think College Family Resource Page

ThinkCollege.Net/family-resources

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For more information:

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thank you!



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